

Yes. We can park the detailed HQ-room map for now and treat the **Prologue as one complete playable mission**.

The Prologue has to do more than introduce characters. It establishes the world, the player's position inside Phantom Q, the normal operating baseline, the first anomaly, and the reason the entire security campaign begins.

Prologue — First Shift at Phantom Q

1. What the Prologue is actually for

The Prologue should make the learner experience:

Normal work → something small feels wrong → verify → something is definitely wrong → preserve what you know → escalate.

The learner should **not yet be solving cybersecurity problems**.

They are not supposed to know:

- CIA terminology;
- encryption;
- symmetric/asymmetric security;
- networking;
- incident response;
- QKD.

They should simply learn to behave like a careful new engineer.

The key emotional outcome is:

I came here to do ordinary work.

Something happened.

I cannot explain it yet.

But I know enough to say:

THIS NEEDS INVESTIGATION.

That is the correct hand-off into Incident 01.

2. Player starting state

The learner begins outside Phantom Q Headquarters.

```
ROLE
New Phantom Q trainee

CLEARANCE
ENTRY / BASIC

TOOLS
None

WORKSTATION
Not yet assigned

INCIDENT ACCESS
None

KNOWN CHARACTERS
None / minimal introductions

SECURITY RESPONSIBILITY
Follow procedure
Observe
Verify before escalating
```

Importantly, the player starts **without privileged tools**.

That matters because progression later has meaning.

3. What the learner should understand about Phantom Q

The Prologue quietly establishes the organisation.

Phantom Q is not presented as:

“A cybersecurity school.”

It is presented as an operating technical organisation.

The learner sees:

```
PHANTOM Q HEADQUARTERS

Central Operations
Training
Cryptography
Communications
SOC
```

Engineering
Red Team
Quantum areas
Restricted areas

Most of it is inaccessible.

That creates curiosity without teaching everything immediately.

4. Core characters introduced

Only the characters relevant to the first operation need attention.

The trainee

The player.

No forced invented name.

Their identity comes from the player profile / fictional Phantom Q training identity.

Alice — sender / source owner

Alice physically brings the files.

Her importance is established before the learner understands why.

She is the person who knows:

What the original file actually was.

That makes her the persistent **source-of-truth/origin perspective** later.

Bob — receiver / verifier

Bob is remote.

He receives the files.

His perspective is:

What actually arrived at the destination?

That becomes important throughout the campaign.

Eve — authorised security support

Eve appears early because she is part of Phantom Q security.

She may:

- assist with the training credential check;
- confirm security procedures;
- later confirm that no authorised test explains the suspicious event.

Critically:

EVE ≠ VILLAIN

She should behave professionally and normally.

5. Credential architecture

We need to make this technically clear from the beginning.

There are two separate identities.

REAL PLATFORM ACCOUNT

Used to access the actual game/platform

≠

PHANTOM Q TRAINING CREDENTIAL

A fictional in-world security object

The Prologue should never accidentally teach learners to enter their real passwords into the simulation.

The game can explicitly say:

Create a fictional Phantom Q training password. Do not reuse a real password.

That is enough.

6. Prologue world path

The learner physically travels:

ENTRANCE
↓
RECEPTION
↓
IDENTITY / REGISTRATION
↓
ACCESS CONTROL
↓
CENTRAL OPERATIONS
↓
WORKSTATION 04

This should happen inside the actual HQ rather than through disconnected menu screens.

7. Prologue full role-play sequence

We already had **16 major beats**. I would keep those and now expand what each one means.

Stage A — Become part of Phantom Q

Scene 1 — Arrival

The trainee arrives at Phantom Q Headquarters.

They see:

- reception;
- visible restricted areas;
- access doors;
- staff moving;
- Central Operations beyond the gate.

The environment should immediately communicate:

This is an operating secure facility.

Player action

Walk to reception.

No tutorial dump

Only a small contextual objective:

OBJECTIVE

Report to Reception

Scene 2 — Registration

Reception opens the trainee profile.

The learner confirms basic fictional in-world details.

The system generates:

PHANTOM Q TRAINEE PROFILE

Player action

Complete registration.

World change

A temporary trainee identity becomes active.

Scene 3 — Create the training credential

Now the system asks:

Create your Phantom Q training credential.

A clear notice:

TRAINING ENVIRONMENT

Use a fictional password.

Do not enter or reuse a real password.

Player action

Create credential.

What this establishes

The learner has created something that later becomes security evidence.

At this point it feels mundane.

That is good.

Scene 4 — Eve performs the authorised credential check

Eve is introduced as security support.

She checks whether the trainee credential works in the Phantom Q training environment.

CREDENTIAL TEST
Authorised by Phantom Q Security

Player action

Approve/participate in the authorised test.

Result

LOGIN TEST
SUCCESS ✓

SECURITY CHECK
COMPLETE ✓

Important later payoff

The learner now has a baseline:

I have seen what an authorised security action looks like.

Later, suspicious activity can be compared against that.

Scene 5 — Initial clearance issued

The trainee receives:

CLEARANCE
TRAINEE / BASIC

The badge/access reader becomes active.

The HQ map briefly shows:

Reception	OPEN
Central Operations	LIMITED
Training	LOCKED
Cryptography	LOCKED
SOC	RESTRICTED
Red Team	LOCKED
Quantum	LOCKED

Player action

Pass through the access gate.

This teaches clearance through the world, not text.

Stage B — Establish normal operations

Scene 6 — Login to Workstation 04

The learner is directed to:

WORKSTATION 04

This becomes a persistent object.

Player logs in using the fictional Phantom Q credential.

```
WORKSTATION 04
USER: TRAINEE
STATUS: ACTIVE
```

Why it matters

This workstation later becomes part of the evidence chain.

Scene 7 — Alice arrives with the USB

Alice physically comes to the workstation.

This is important — not just a chat window.

She says she needs the files sent to Bob.

The USB is inserted.

Files appear:

01_LAYOUT.PNG

02_REPORT.PDF

Alice initially believes those are the files she needs sent.

Bob appears remotely through the communication interface:

BOB

REMOTE

WAITING

Player action

Inspect the USB/file list.

Scene 8 — Send File 1

Player selects:

01_LAYOUT.PNG

and sends it.

Bob confirms:

01_LAYOUT.PNG

RECEIVED ✓

Why we need this

This creates **normal behaviour**.

No cybersecurity lesson yet.

Scene 9 — Send File 2

Player sends:

02_REPORT.PDF

Bob:

02_REPORT.PDF

RECEIVED ✓

Now we have two successful transfers.

The learner has formed an expectation:

Alice gives file

↓

I send file

↓

Bob receives file

Exactly what we need before breaking it.

Stage C — Introduce the anomaly

Scene 10 — Alice returns

Alice comes back.

She says she forgot a third file.

USB now contains:

03_ACCESS_SCHEDULE.XLSX

This file becomes extremely important.

Player action

Confirm file and prepare transfer.

No warning.

Nothing dramatic.

Scene 11 — First transfer fails

The learner sends:

03_ACCESS_SCHEDULE.XLSX

Their workstation indicates:

TRANSFER SENT

But Bob says:

“I haven’t received anything.”

This is the first anomaly.

Important design

Do **not** immediately show:

SECURITY INCIDENT!!!

The learner first experiences uncertainty.

Player options might include

CHECK FILE

CHECK BOB

RETRY

REPORT

We should encourage verification before escalation.

Scene 12 — Verify with Alice and retry

The learner checks with Alice:

Is this definitely the correct file?

Alice confirms.

ALICE SOURCE

03_ACCESS_SCHEDULE.XLSX

CONFIRMED

Then retry.

This is important because later Incident 01 begins teaching **source** → **transfer** → **receiver** reasoning.

The Prologue seeds that behaviour without naming it.

Scene 13 — Bob receives an altered file

This time Bob receives:

```
03_ACCESS_SCHEDULE.XLSX
```

but something is wrong.

He reports that the contents do not match what Alice expects.

We should avoid a giant forensic comparison here.

Just enough:

```
ALICE ORIGINAL  
≠  
BOB RECEIVED
```

Bob:

“This doesn't look right.”

Alice:

“That's not the version I gave you.”

Now the learner knows:

```
FIRST SEND  
NOT RECEIVED  
  
SECOND SEND  
RECEIVED BUT DIFFERENT
```

This is the incident seed.

Stage D — Add the identity/trust anomaly

Scene 14 — Credential activity appears

During verification, a workstation/security notice appears.

Something like:

```
TRAINING CREDENTIAL ACTIVITY
```

LOGIN EVENT
UNRECOGNISED

STATUS
REQUIRES REVIEW

We must be careful not to reveal the actor.

The player sees only:

ACCOUNT ACTIVITY
SUSPICIOUS

not:

EVE LOGIN

or:

ATTACKER LOGIN

Scene 15 — Check whether Eve's authorised activity explains it

Because Eve performed the earlier authorised credential check, the learner/security team asks:

Was this part of your test?

Eve checks her authorised test record.

Result:

EVE AUTHORISED TEST

Earlier credential test	COMPLETE ✓
Current activity	NOT AUTHORISED

This is one of the most important Prologue moments.

It establishes:

SECURITY ACTIVITY EXISTS
BUT

Eve becomes a useful witness/security reference, not a suspect by default.

Stage E — Escalate correctly

Scene 16 — Create PQ-001

The learner now has enough to escalate.

Not enough to solve.

The system gathers:

```
03_ACCESS_SCHEDULE.XLSX
```

```
Transfer attempt 1:
```

```
Not received
```

```
Transfer attempt 2:
```

```
Received altered
```

```
Credential activity:
```

```
Unrecognised
```

```
Alice:
```

```
Original confirmed
```

```
Bob:
```

```
Received copy differs
```

```
Eve authorised test:
```

```
No active test explaining event
```

The learner submits:

REPORT INCIDENT

Incident created:

```
PQ-001
```

8. What should the learner physically do?

The Prologue should contain actual interaction.

The learner:

1. walks into Headquarters;
2. registers;
3. creates the fictional credential;
4. participates in Eve's authorised credential test;
5. scans/uses their access badge;
6. walks to Workstation 04;
7. logs in;
8. connects/opens Alice's USB;
9. inspects files;
10. sends File 1;
11. confirms Bob received it;
12. sends File 2;
13. confirms Bob received it;
14. accepts Alice's forgotten third file;
15. sends File 3;
16. notices Bob did not receive it;
17. checks the source with Alice;
18. retries;
19. compares Alice/Bob reports;
20. opens suspicious credential notice;
21. checks authorised activity with Eve;
22. submits PQ-001.

That is already meaningful gameplay without teaching formal security concepts.

9. Information flow — what the player knows when

This is critical.

Beginning

Player knows only:

```
I am a new trainee.  
I need to register.
```

After Eve's check

My training credential works.
Eve performed an authorised security test.

After File 1 and File 2

The transfer process appears normal.
Alice sends through me.
Bob receives.

After File 3 attempt 1

I sent it.
Bob did not receive it.

Nothing else.

After retry

Bob now has a file.
Alice says the contents are wrong.

After credential notice

Something unusual also happened with the training credential.

After checking with Eve

The suspicious event was not part of Eve's authorised activity.

End

Player knows:

FILE DELIVERY PROBLEM

YES

FILE CHANGE

YES

SUSPICIOUS CREDENTIAL ACTIVITY

YES

CAUSE

UNKNOWN

ACTOR

UNKNOWN

That information boundary must be strict.

10. What the player must NOT know yet

Do not reveal:

- CIA terminology;
- malware;
- man-in-the-middle attack;
- shared-key compromise;
- network relay;
- IP address;
- Eve interception;
- encryption;
- Phantom identity;
- exact attack method.

The Prologue is evidence creation, not explanation.

11. Success and poor-decision behaviour

We should already establish our campaign rule:

Poor decisions create believable consequences, not generic “wrong answer” popups.

Example — send without checking the file

The transfer still happens.

The player may later have weaker evidence about the original source.

Example — immediately accuse Eve

System should not say:

WRONG

Instead:

ACCUSATION CANNOT BE SUPPORTED

Known:

Eve performed an authorised earlier test.

Unknown:

Who caused current activity.

This teaches evidence discipline before Incident 01 formalises it.

Example — repeatedly retry without verifying Alice

Perhaps:

SOURCE NOT RECONFIRMED

and the game directs the learner toward checking the source before additional attempts.

Example — ignore the credential alert

The incident report cannot be completed:

UNREVIEWED SECURITY EVENT

so the player must inspect it.

12. What is actually being taught underneath

Although the learner isn't given the vocabulary yet, the Prologue quietly introduces:

Gameplay event	Concept underneath
Alice has original file	Source of truth
Bob receives file	Destination
File not received	Availability
File changed	Integrity
Credential anomaly	Identity/access
Authorised Eve test	Authorised vs unauthorised activity
Verify before accusing	Evidence-based reasoning
Incident report	Escalation
Normal Files 1–2	Baseline behaviour

Incident 01 then gives names to what the learner has already experienced.

That is much better than teaching definitions first.

13. Persistent evidence created by the Prologue

The Prologue should generate real in-game artefacts that later investigations reuse.

PQ-001

contains:

File artefacts

01_LAYOUT.PNG
02_REPORT.PDF
03_ACCESS_SCHEDULE.XLSX

Source evidence

Alice confirmation
USB/file source record

Transfer evidence

```
File 1 successful
File 2 successful
File 3 attempt 1
File 3 attempt 2
```

Receiver evidence

```
Bob receipt confirmations
Bob altered-file report
```

Identity evidence

```
Trainee credential creation
Eve authorised credential test
Unrecognised later credential activity
```

Time evidence

Each event should have timestamps internally even if the learner does not yet deeply analyse them.

This is important because later incidents rely heavily on timelines.

14. Character behaviour through the Prologue

Alice

Starts relaxed and task-focused.

Then confused.

Then concerned.

She never suddenly turns into a security lecturer.

Her role is:

“That is not what I sent.”

Bob

Initially routine and responsive.

Then:

“I haven't received it.”

Then:

“I received something, but this isn't right.”

He is not incompetent.

He is reporting destination-state evidence.

Eve

Professional security support.

Early:

authorised credential check.

Later:

checks whether current suspicious activity belongs to her test.

Answer:

no.

She should remain calm and analytical.

Trainee

The emotional arc is:

NEW

↓

COMFORTABLE

↓

CONFUSED

↓

CAREFUL

↓

CONCERNED



RESPONSIBLE

That is the player's first progression.

15. Environmental progression during the Prologue

The HQ should react as the incident develops.

Beginning

HQ STATUS

NORMAL

Bright, normal operations.

After first failed File 3 transfer

Very subtle.

Maybe Workstation 04 status marker changes.

No alarms.

After altered file + credential anomaly

LOCAL SECURITY REVIEW

SOC activity becomes visible in the background.

Maybe a restricted indicator appears.

PQ-001 creation

HQ SECURITY STATUS

ACTIVE INVESTIGATION

Then:

FOUNDATIONS ACCESS UNLOCKED

This should be the first meaningful clearance progression.

16. Prologue end-state board

The final Prologue state should be extremely precise.

PROLOGUE – PQ-001

01_LAYOUT.PNG

Delivered normally ✓

02_REPORT.PDF

Delivered normally ✓

03_ACCESS_SCHEDULE.XLSX

Attempt 1: Not received

Attempt 2: Received altered

Alice source

Confirmed ✓

Bob destination

Mismatch confirmed ✓

Credential activity

Suspicious ⚠

Eve authorised test

Does not explain current activity

Actor

UNKNOWN

Root cause

UNKNOWN

Then:

INCIDENT PQ-001 OPENED

and:

FOUNDATIONS UNLOCKED

17. Why Incident 01 becomes necessary

The learner has evidence, but no framework.

They know:

Something failed.

They do not yet know:

WHAT KIND OF SECURITY FAILURE?

WHAT CAN WE PROVE?

WHAT ARE WE ASSUMING?

WHAT SHOULD WE INVESTIGATE FIRST?

Therefore Incident 01 naturally begins with:

Understand the Incident.

That is the clean hand-off.

Prologue master flow

```
ARRIVE
↓
REGISTER
↓
CREATE TRAINING CREDENTIAL
↓
EVE AUTHORISED CHECK
↓
RECEIVE BASIC CLEARANCE
↓
WORKSTATION 04
↓
ALICE ARRIVES WITH USB
↓
FILE 1 → BOB ✓
↓
FILE 2 → BOB ✓
↓
NORMAL BASELINE ESTABLISHED
↓
ALICE RETURNS WITH FILE 3
↓
FILE 3 SEND
↓
BOB RECEIVES NOTHING
↓
VERIFY WITH ALICE
↓
```


RETRY

↓

BOB RECEIVES ALTERED FILE

↓

ALICE CONFIRMS MISMATCH

↓

CREDENTIAL ANOMALY APPEARS

↓

CHECK EVE AUTHORISED ACTIVITY

↓

NO AUTHORISED TEST EXPLAINS IT

↓

PRESERVE KNOWN FACTS

↓

CREATE PQ-001

↓

FOUNDATIONS UNLOCKED

That is the **complete Prologue specification at the campaign level**. The next pass should be to break this down further into **actual gameplay mechanics per scene — camera position, player controls, UI prompts, NPC movement/dialogue, what is clickable, what is hidden, and what happens if the player makes a poor choice —** while keeping this storyline unchanged.